

SWAAGAT Excise Services Selection Guide

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Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Status: Published — Department Verified and Approved for Chatbot Use

Purpose: To help users identify the correct Excise service based on their proposed activity.

This guide covers the active Excise services listed in the SWAAGAT service catalog, excluding the test service.

1. Purpose of This Guide

This guide helps applicants distinguish between Excise services relating to:

- Breweries
- Distilleries
- Foreign liquor bottling plants
- Country liquor bottling plants
- Use and storage of denatured spirit
- Wholesale supply of denatured spirit
- Bar licences
- Supplier registration
- Label registration

This document is only for identifying the most relevant service.

It does not define:

- Required documents
- Government fees
- Eligibility thresholds
- Processing timelines
- Approval stages
- Licence validity
- Renewal rules
- Actual application status

Those details must come from the latest service configuration and live SWAAGAT data.

2. General Service-Selection Rules

Before recommending an Excise service, identify the applicant's actual business activity.

The chatbot should ask:

1. What activity do you intend to carry out?
2. Will you manufacture, bottle, store, supply, sell, or serve the product?
3. Does the activity involve a brewery or distillery?
4. Is the bottling plant for foreign liquor or country liquor?
5. Does the requirement concern denatured spirit?
6. Are you applying for a business licence, supplier registration, or product-label registration?
7. Is the applicant starting a new operation or updating an existing approval?

Do not recommend a service merely because the user mentions liquor, alcohol, spirit, bar, brewery, or excise.

When the user's activity is unclear, ask a clarification question before selecting a service.

3. Quick Service-Selection Guide

The applicant wants to establish or operate a brewery

Consider:

Service ID 86 — Application For LOI and Licence for Brewery

Confirm that the applicant's activity is related to establishing or operating a brewery.

The applicant wants to establish or operate a distillery

Consider:

Service ID 114 — Application for LOI and Licence Distillery

Confirm that the activity concerns a distillery rather than a brewery or bottling plant.

The applicant wants to establish a foreign-liquor bottling plant

Consider:

Service ID 115 — Application for LOI and License for Bottling Plant (FL)

Confirm that “FL” refers to the applicable foreign-liquor category under the department’s verified terminology.

The applicant wants to establish a country-liquor bottling plant

Consider:

Service ID 116 — Application for LOI and License for Bottling Plant (CL)

Confirm that “CL” refers to the applicable country-liquor category under the department’s verified terminology.

The applicant wants to use or store denatured spirit

Consider:

Service ID 117 — Application for License for Use and Storage of Denature Spirit

Confirm that the user needs possession, use, or storage for their own authorised activity and is not applying as a wholesale supplier.

The applicant wants to sell or supply denatured spirit on a wholesale basis

Consider:

Service ID 118 — Application for License for Wholesale Denature Spirit

Confirm that the user’s activity is wholesale supply rather than only use or storage.

The applicant wants to operate a bar

Consider:

Service ID 119 — Application for Bar License

Confirm the type of establishment and that the requirement concerns serving alcoholic beverages at the premises.

Detailed establishment eligibility must be verified from the service configuration or department.

The applicant wants to register as a supplier

Consider:

Service ID 120 — Application for Supplier Registration

Confirm what products the applicant intends to supply and whether supplier registration is the correct department process.

The applicant wants to register a product label

Consider:

Service ID 121 — Application for Label Registration

Confirm that the request concerns registration or approval of a product label rather than registration of the supplier or manufacturing unit.

4. Individual Service Profiles

4.1 Application For LOI and Licence for Brewery

Service ID: 86

Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Service mode: Third-party

CAF required: No, according to the current service catalog

Common names and user phrases

- Brewery licence
- Brewery LOI
- Beer manufacturing licence
- Permission to start a brewery

- Brewery registration
- I want to open a brewery
- Beer plant ke liye kaunsa licence chahiye?
- Brewery start karne ke liye approval

Who should consider this service?

An applicant proposing to establish or operate a brewery should consider this service.

The exact eligibility conditions and permitted activities require departmental verification.

Consider this service when

- The proposed unit is a brewery.
- The applicant wants the applicable Letter of Intent and licence.
- The planned activity concerns brewery operations rather than only bottling, supply, retail sale, or serving beverages.

Do not recommend this service when

- The applicant wants to establish a distillery.
- The applicant only wants to establish a bottling plant.
- The applicant wants a bar licence.
- The applicant only wants supplier registration.
- The applicant only wants label registration.

Clarification questions

1. Are you planning to establish a brewery or a distillery?
2. Will manufacturing take place at the proposed unit?
3. Do you need approval for a new establishment?
4. Are you applying for the manufacturing unit, bottling activity, or product label?

Related or easily confused services

- Service 114 — Application for LOI and Licence Distillery
- Service 115 — Bottling Plant (FL)
- Service 116 — Bottling Plant (CL)
- Service 121 — Label Registration

Recommendation restriction

Do not recommend the brewery service merely because the user mentions beer. Confirm that the proposed activity involves establishing or operating a brewery.

4.2 Application for LOI and Licence Distillery

Service ID: 114

Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Service mode: Third-party

CAF required: No, according to the current service catalog

Common names and user phrases

- Distillery licence
- Distillery LOI
- Alcohol manufacturing plant licence
- Permission to start a distillery
- Distillery registration
- I want to open a distillery
- Distillery ke liye licence
- Spirit manufacturing unit approval

Who should consider this service?

An applicant proposing to establish or operate a distillery should consider this service.

The precise scope of manufacturing and departmental conditions must be verified.

Consider this service when

- The proposed unit is a distillery.
- The applicant needs the applicable Letter of Intent and licence.
- The activity involves distillery operations and not only bottling, wholesale supply, or retail service.

Do not recommend this service when

- The applicant wants to establish a brewery.
- The applicant only wants a bottling plant.
- The requirement is limited to denatured-spirit storage or wholesale supply.
- The user needs a bar licence.
- The user only needs label registration.

Clarification questions

1. Is the proposed unit a distillery or a brewery?
2. What product or spirit will the proposed unit manufacture?
3. Is this a new establishment?
4. Will bottling also take place at the same unit?

Related or easily confused services

- Service 86 — Brewery
- Service 115 — Bottling Plant (FL)
- Service 116 — Bottling Plant (CL)
- Service 117 — Use and Storage of Denatured Spirit
- Service 118 — Wholesale Denatured Spirit

Recommendation restriction

Do not treat every alcohol-manufacturing question as a distillery application. First distinguish the distillery from brewery and bottling activities.

4.3 Application for LOI and License for Bottling Plant (FL)

Service ID: 115

Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Service mode: Third-party

CAF required: No, according to the current service catalog

Common names and user phrases

- Foreign liquor bottling plant licence
- FL bottling licence
- Liquor bottling unit approval
- Bottling plant LOI
- I want to start a foreign liquor bottling plant
- FL bottling plant ke liye licence
- Alcohol bottling unit permission

Who should consider this service?

An applicant proposing to establish or operate a bottling plant under the applicable FL category should consider this service.

The department must verify the exact meaning and scope of the FL category.

Consider this service when

- The proposed activity is bottling under the FL category.
- The applicant needs the applicable Letter of Intent and licence.
- The requirement concerns a bottling unit rather than a brewery, distillery, bar, supplier registration, or label registration alone.

Do not recommend this service when

- The proposed plant falls under the CL category.
- The applicant wants to establish a brewery or distillery.
- The applicant only wants product-label registration.
- The applicant wants a bar licence.
- The applicant wants supplier registration.

Clarification questions

1. Is the bottling plant for foreign liquor or country liquor?
2. Is this a new bottling plant?
3. Will manufacturing also occur at the proposed unit?
4. Do you separately require label registration?

Related or easily confused services

- Service 116 — Bottling Plant (CL)
- Service 86 — Brewery
- Service 114 — Distillery
- Service 121 — Label Registration

Recommendation restriction

Do not recommend the FL bottling service until the applicable liquor category has been confirmed.

4.4 Application for LOI and License for Bottling Plant (CL)

Service ID: 116

Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Service mode: Third-party

CAF required: No, according to the current service catalog

Common names and user phrases

- Country liquor bottling plant licence
- CL bottling licence
- Country liquor bottling unit approval
- Bottling plant LOI
- I want to start a country liquor bottling plant
- CL bottling plant ke liye licence

Who should consider this service?

An applicant proposing to establish or operate a bottling plant under the applicable CL category should consider this service.

The department must verify the exact meaning and scope of the CL category.

Consider this service when

- The proposed activity is bottling under the CL category.
- The applicant requires the applicable Letter of Intent and licence.
- The activity concerns the bottling plant and not only label registration or supplier registration.

Do not recommend this service when

- The proposed unit falls under the FL category.
- The applicant wants to establish a brewery or distillery.
- The applicant only wants to operate a bar.
- The applicant only needs supplier or label registration.

Clarification questions

1. Is the bottling plant for country liquor or foreign liquor?
2. Is this a new plant?
3. Does the proposed unit also manufacture the product?
4. Is separate label registration required?

Related or easily confused services

- Service 115 — Bottling Plant (FL)
- Service 86 — Brewery
- Service 114 — Distillery
- Service 121 — Label Registration

Recommendation restriction

Do not select between FL and CL bottling services based only on the word “bottling.” Ask the user to confirm the category.

4.5 Application for License for Use and Storage of Denature Spirit

Service ID: 117

Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Service mode: Third-party

CAF required: No, according to the current service catalog

Common names and user phrases

- Denatured spirit storage licence
- Denature spirit use licence
- Licence to possess denatured spirit
- Permission to store industrial spirit
- I use denatured spirit in my business
- Denature spirit store karne ka licence
- Industrial use ke liye spirit permission

Who should consider this service?

An applicant who needs authorisation to use or store denatured spirit for an approved activity should consider this service.

The permitted use, storage limit, premises requirements, and applicant categories must be verified by the department.

Consider this service when

- The applicant intends to use denatured spirit.
- The applicant intends to store denatured spirit.
- The denatured spirit is required for the applicant's own authorised business or industrial activity.
- The applicant is not primarily applying as a wholesale supplier.

Do not recommend this service when

- The applicant wants to sell or distribute denatured spirit wholesale.
- The request concerns a distillery licence.
- The request concerns a bar licence.
- The applicant only needs supplier registration for another Excise activity.

Clarification questions

1. Will you use the denatured spirit or sell it?
2. Will it be stored at your premises?
3. What is the intended business or industrial use?
4. Are you applying as the end user or as a wholesale supplier?

Related or easily confused services

- Service 118 — Wholesale Denatured Spirit
- Service 114 — Distillery
- Service 120 — Supplier Registration

Recommendation restriction

The words “purchase,” “supply,” and “storage” are not interchangeable. Confirm whether the applicant is an end user or a wholesale supplier.

4.6 Application for License for Wholesale Denature Spirit

Service ID: 118

Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Service mode: Third-party

CAF required: No, according to the current service catalog

Common names and user phrases

- Wholesale denatured spirit licence
- Denature spirit supplier licence
- Industrial spirit wholesale licence
- Licence to sell denatured spirit
- I want to supply denatured spirit
- Denature spirit wholesale business
- Spirit dealer licence

Who should consider this service?

An applicant proposing to undertake wholesale supply or sale of denatured spirit should consider this service.

The department must verify the precise wholesale activities covered.

Consider this service when

- The applicant intends to supply or sell denatured spirit wholesale.
- The applicant is operating as a wholesaler rather than only an end user.
- The request concerns the applicable wholesale licence.

Do not recommend this service when

- The applicant only needs denatured spirit for internal use.
- The applicant only wants to store denatured spirit for their own operations.

- The request concerns a distillery, bottling plant, or bar.
- The user only wants general supplier registration without confirming the denatured-spirit activity.

Clarification questions

1. Are you purchasing denatured spirit for your own use or selling it to others?
2. Will you operate as a wholesale supplier?
3. Will you also store the product at your premises?
4. Do you require any additional supplier registration?

Related or easily confused services

- Service 117 — Use and Storage of Denatured Spirit
- Service 120 — Supplier Registration
- Service 114 — Distillery

Recommendation restriction

Do not recommend the wholesale licence to an applicant who only consumes or stores denatured spirit for their own authorised use.

4.7 Application for Bar License

Service ID: 119

Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Service mode: Third-party

CAF required: No, according to the current service catalog

Common names and user phrases

- Bar licence
- Liquor-serving licence
- Restaurant bar licence
- Hotel bar licence
- Permission to serve alcohol
- I want to open a bar
- Restaurant me liquor serve karna hai
- Hotel ke liye bar licence

Who should consider this service?

An applicant proposing to serve alcoholic beverages at an eligible establishment should consider this service.

The eligible establishment types and permitted activities require department verification.

Consider this service when

- The proposed activity is operating a bar.
- The establishment intends to serve alcoholic beverages.
- The applicant needs the relevant bar licence for the premises.

Do not recommend this service when

- The applicant wants to manufacture liquor.
- The applicant wants to establish a brewery, distillery, or bottling plant.
- The applicant only wants to supply liquor wholesale.
- The applicant only needs a product-label registration.

Clarification questions

1. What type of establishment will operate the bar?
2. Is it a hotel, restaurant, club, or another premises type?
3. Will alcoholic beverages be served for consumption at the premises?
4. Is this a new licence or a change to an existing establishment?

Related or easily confused services

- Service 120 — Supplier Registration
- Service 121 — Label Registration
- Service 86 — Brewery
- Service 114 — Distillery

Recommendation restriction

Do not assume every restaurant, hotel, or event automatically qualifies. Eligibility must be checked from verified department rules.

4.8 Application for Supplier Registration

Service ID: 120

Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Service mode: Third-party

CAF required: No, according to the current service catalog

Common names and user phrases

- Excise supplier registration
- Liquor supplier registration
- Register as alcohol supplier
- Excise vendor registration
- I want to become a supplier
- Supplier registration kaise kare?
- Excise department supplier approval

Who should consider this service?

An applicant who needs to register as a supplier under the applicable Excise process should consider this service.

The products and applicant categories covered by this registration require departmental verification.

Consider this service when

- The applicant intends to register as a supplier.
- The business activity falls within the Excise supplier-registration process.
- The requirement is registration of the supplier rather than licensing of a manufacturing plant or bar.

Do not recommend this service when

- The applicant wants to establish a brewery, distillery, or bottling plant.
- The applicant wants a bar licence.
- The user only wants to register a product label.
- The activity specifically requires a wholesale denatured-spirit licence.

Clarification questions

1. What product do you intend to supply?
2. Are you applying as a manufacturer, wholesaler, distributor, or another supplier type?
3. Do you already hold any related Excise licence?
4. Do you also require product-label registration?

Related or easily confused services

- Service 121 — Label Registration
- Service 118 — Wholesale Denatured Spirit
- Service 115 — Bottling Plant (FL)
- Service 116 — Bottling Plant (CL)

Recommendation restriction

Do not treat supplier registration as a replacement for an activity-specific licence.

4.9 Application for Label Registration

Service ID: 121

Department: Commissionerate of Excise

Service mode: Third-party

CAF required: No, according to the current service catalog

Common names and user phrases

- Liquor label registration
- Alcohol label approval
- Excise label registration
- Brand label approval
- Bottle label registration
- I want to register a liquor label
- Product label approve karwana hai
- Brand registration for excise product

Who should consider this service?

An applicant seeking registration or approval of an applicable product label should consider this service.

The products, brands, packages, and label categories covered must be verified by the department.

Consider this service when

- The applicant needs approval or registration for a product label.
- The requirement concerns branding or labelling of an Excise-regulated product.
- The applicant already understands that any separate business or manufacturing licence may also be required.

Do not recommend this service when

- The user only wants to register as a supplier.
- The user wants to establish a brewery, distillery, or bottling plant.
- The request concerns a bar licence.
- The request concerns general company or trademark registration outside the Excise process.

Clarification questions

1. Which product or brand label do you want to register?
2. Are you the manufacturer, bottler, supplier, or authorised applicant?
3. Do you already hold the related business or manufacturing approval?
4. Is this a new label, revised label, or additional product label?

Related or easily confused services

- Service 120 — Supplier Registration
- Service 115 — Bottling Plant (FL)
- Service 116 — Bottling Plant (CL)
- Service 86 — Brewery
- Service 114 — Distillery

Recommendation restriction

Label registration should not be presented as permission to manufacture, bottle, supply, sell, or serve the product.

5. Important Distinctions

Brewery vs Distillery

A brewery-related activity should be considered separately from a distillery-related activity.

The chatbot must ask which type of manufacturing establishment the applicant intends to operate.

Do not use the terms interchangeably.

Manufacturing vs Bottling

A brewery or distillery service concerns the relevant manufacturing establishment.

A bottling-plant service concerns the applicable bottling activity.

One project may require more than one approval, but the chatbot should not claim that automatically without verified rules.

FL Bottling vs CL Bottling

The chatbot must confirm the applicable product category before recommending:

- Service 115 for FL
- Service 116 for CL

The meaning and legal classification of these abbreviations must be verified by the department.

Denatured Spirit Use and Storage vs Wholesale

Recommend Service 117 when the applicant requires denatured spirit for their own authorised use or storage.

Consider Service 118 when the applicant proposes wholesale supply or sale.

Always ask whether the user is the end user or wholesale supplier.

Supplier Registration vs Label Registration

Supplier registration concerns registration of the supplier.

Label registration concerns approval or registration of a product label.

A user may potentially need both, but one does not automatically replace the other.

Bar Licence vs Manufacturing Licence

A bar licence relates to serving alcoholic beverages at an eligible premises.

It is not a brewery, distillery, bottling, supplier, or label-registration approval.

6. Example Discovery Conversations

Example 1 — Brewery

User: I want to start a beer manufacturing unit. Which service should I select?

Assistant: Are you planning to establish a brewery where beer will be manufactured, or only a bottling unit?

User: It will be a brewery.

Recommended candidate:

Service 86 — Application For LOI and Licence for Brewery.

Example 2 — Distillery

User: I want to manufacture spirit. Which Excise approval is required?

Assistant: Will the proposed unit operate as a distillery, and are you applying for a new establishment?

User: Yes, it is a new distillery.

Recommended candidate:

Service 114 — Application for LOI and Licence Distillery.

Example 3 — Bottling Plant

User: I want to open a liquor bottling plant.

Assistant: Is the proposed bottling plant for the FL category or the CL category?

The chatbot should not recommend a specific service until the category is confirmed.

Example 4 — Denatured Spirit

User: I require denatured spirit for industrial use.

Assistant: Will you use and store it for your own industrial activity, or will you sell it to other businesses?

User: It is for our own use.

Recommended candidate:

Service 117 — Licence for Use and Storage of Denature Spirit.

Example 5 — Wholesale Denatured Spirit

User: I want to supply denatured spirit to businesses.

Assistant: Will you operate as a wholesale supplier?

User: Yes.

Recommended candidate:

Service 118 — Licence for Wholesale Denature Spirit.

Example 6 — Bar

User: I want to serve alcohol in my restaurant.

Assistant: Are you seeking permission to operate a bar and serve alcoholic beverages at the restaurant premises?

After confirmation, the candidate may be:

Service 119 — Application for Bar License.

Eligibility must still be verified using official service rules.

Example 7 — Supplier and Label

User: I want to supply liquor under my brand.

Assistant: Do you need registration as a supplier, registration of the product label, or both?

Possible candidates:

- Service 120 — Supplier Registration
- Service 121 — Label Registration

The chatbot should explain the distinction and ask the user to select the required process.

7. Chatbot Recommendation Rules

The chatbot must:

- Use only service names and IDs verified in SWAAGAT.
- Ask a clarification question when multiple Excise services could apply.
- Distinguish manufacturing, bottling, storage, supply, sale, serving, and label registration.
- Distinguish brewery and distillery activities.
- Distinguish FL and CL bottling categories.
- Distinguish use/storage of denatured spirit from wholesale supply.
- Distinguish supplier registration from label registration.
- State that a service “may be applicable” until verified eligibility is available.
- Allow the user to select the recommended service.
- Use the selected service’s generated knowledge for documents, CAF, fees, processing time, approval flow, and certificate details.

The chatbot must not:

- Invent statutory thresholds.
- Invent applicant eligibility.
- Invent product classifications.
- Invent documents, fees, licence validity, or processing time.
- Treat label registration as a manufacturing or sales licence.
- Treat supplier registration as a substitute for an activity-specific licence.
- Recommend a service only because the user uses the word “alcohol” or “liquor.”
- Claim that the user is legally authorised merely because a candidate service was identified.